STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-7400

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **01/10/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE	RESOURCES
GENERAL	

SUBJECT	CROSS REFERENCE
PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES	G-6120 USE OF FORCE RESULTING IN DEATH OR SERIOUS INJURY G-7100 SICK LEAVE G-7200 JOB RELATED INJURIES G-7600 EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for available psychological services and specific psychological services for critical incidents (e.g. shooting incidents).

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall provide access to a licensed psychologist for a variety of purposes. The psychologist shall be made available to any employee involved in a use of force resulting in death or serious injury. The psychologist shall also be available for other matters as described in this policy. The availability of volunteer and staff psychologists are in addition to the Employee Assistance Program (see G-7600 Employee Assistance Program).

III. Procedures:

A. Sheriff's Office Staff Psychologist: The Sheriff's Office shall contract with a licensed psychologist(s).

1. The staff psychologist(s) shall provide the following basic psychological services:

a) Recommendations for fitness-for-duty.

(1) Fitness-for-duty recommendations and critical incident stress management shall not be provided by the same psychologist.

b) Counseling services to employees and their immediate families, as a result of a mandatory referral.

c) Pre-employment evaluations for sworn employee candidates.

2. Psychological services are available to all sworn and non-sworn employees who need assistance with stress related issues. The decision to consult with the staff psychologist can be made by the individual employee or through a referral from his or her supervisor. Supervisor referrals require approval from the Sheriff or Chief Deputy.

a) The Administrative Personnel manager shall maintain contact information for the staff psychologist.

b) Supervisors should remain aware of the potential need for psychological services for employees who have been involved in any critical incident.

B. **Sheriff's Office Volunteer Psychologist:** The Sheriff's Office may retain a licensed psychologist on a volunteer basis.

1. The Sheriff's Office volunteer psychologist may participate in the following activities:

a) Informal personal consultations with Sheriff's Office employees to include stress management information and referrals when appropriate.

(1) All conversations with the Sheriff's Office psychologist during personal consultations shall be confidential unless the psychologist believes the employee is a danger to himself, herself, or others.

b) Consultations with the administration on matters having a psycho-social dimension including:

(1) Determinations whether a fitness-for-duty evaluation is warranted.
(2) Investigation assistance.
(3) Criminal profiles.
(4) Training, to include attending training as a participant or observer.
(5) Staff meetings.

c) On-scene support during critical incidents.

d) Critical incident stress management interventions as requested by the Sheriff's Office in cooperation with the Nebraska Statewide Critical Incident Stress Management Program.

2. The volunteer psychologist shall not engage in the following:

a) Professional assessments or evaluations.

b) Professional counseling or psychotherapy other than brief, informal consultations.

c) Fitness-for-duty evaluations.

C. Psychological Services for Use of Force Resulting in Death or Serious Injury: Psychological services, including Critical Incident Stress Management (CISM), shall be made available to any Sheriff's Office employee involved in a use of force resulting in death or serious injury. Psychological services shall also be made available to the employee's family, if necessary.

1. In all use of force incidents resulting in death or serious injury, including injuries resulting from the discharge of a firearm or after a deputy involved shooting, the involved employee shall be required to be psychologically cleared for duty by the Sheriff's Office furnished psychologist within two (2) days of the incident.

D. Critical Incident Stress Management Procedures: The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall provide professional assistance to assist employees cope with the severe stress inherent in critical incidents in order to minimize stress-related trauma.

1. Any information acquired during a stress management session shall remain confidential within statutory guidelines.

2. There are several types of critical incident interventions from individual or group stress management sessions to individual psychotherapy. The assigned mental health professional and involved employee(s) shall determine the appropriate intervention.

3. Other employees at the scene of the incident may also be requested to undergo an individual or group stress management session.

4. Individual or group stress management sessions shall not be related to or available to any investigation of the incident and nothing discussed in the individual or group stress management session shall be reported to the Sheriff's Office.

5. Mandatory individual or group stress management session:

a) A mandatory individual or group stress management session is required for incidents involving serious life-threatening injury or death of emergency service workers occurring on or off duty. These incidents include but are not limited to:

(1) Use of force incidents resulting in death or serious injury (as described).
(2) Discharge of a firearm with intent to use deadly force (even if there is no death or injury).
(3) Mass casualty incidents.
(4) Suicide or sudden death of a co-worker.
(5) Events that seriously threaten the lives of the responders.
(6) Incidents involving employees taken as hostages.

b) The supervisor or command officer in charge of the scene shall immediately notify the Administrative Commander and provide the names of the personnel for whom the individual or group stress management session is intended. The Administrative Commander shall arrange for the individual or group stress management session.

6. Supervisor Initiated Individual or Group Stress Management Session: Supervisors and command officers may request an individual or group stress management session for their staff following a serious incident by contacting the Administrative Commander.

7. Employee Initiated Individual or Group Stress Management Session: Employees should not hesitate to request an individual or group stress management session.

a) Employees may make a request for an individual or group stress management session to their supervisor or command officer.

b) Employees may contact Employee Assistance and request an individual or group stress management session or other critical incident intervention (see G-7600 Employee Assistance Program).

8. **Relief from Duty:** Following the resolution of a critical incident, supervisors or command officers may recommend that employees go off duty temporarily. This may include allowing employees to determine for themselves when they are prepared to return to service during the shift.

a) The employee may determine that he or she cannot return to duty, or a mental health professional may recommend relief from duty for the

balance of the shift. If this is the case, the supervisor shall be responsible for making the appropriate arrangements.

b) Under no circumstances shall this temporary relief from duty be construed as critical or negative.

c) Long term relief from duty after a critical incident shall fall under sick leave or job related injury procedures, as appropriate (see G-7100 Sick Leave and G-7200 Job Related Injuries).